



NOKUTHULA CENTRE AND SPECIAL SCHOOL

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NOKUTHULA SPECIAL SCHOOL ASSESSMENT POLICY

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TITTLE OF THE POLICY : SCHOOL ASSESSMENT POLICY

1.Effective Date : 12 May 2023

2.Date of next Review 30 November 2024

3.Revision History

As amended on :(specify date) 12 April 2023

4.Preamble :

This policy is formulated in line with Differentiated Curriculum Assessment Policy Statement(DECAPS) for Grade R-5. This forms the basis for on-going curriculum development delivery and assessment for grade R-5. This policy will govern the assessment and evaluation of learners in the whole school. All stakeholders are expected to adhere to the policy

5.Vision and Mission of Assessment

5.1 Assessment Vision

Every learner feels valued and inspired in our innovative Education System.

5.2 Assessment mission

Provide a real, exciting, creative and individualized curriculum that is accessible to Learners with severe to profound intellectual disabilities and Autism Spectrum disorder to ensure a holistic Learning environment.

6.Purpose of the Policy

The purpose of the Assessment policy is to govern the Assessment process and the Evaluation of learners at Nokuthula Special school. To ensure monitoring of learners progress through teaching and learning so that support can be provided to every learner attending Nokuthula Special school,

7.ACRONYMS AND DEFINITIONS

No	Acronyms	Definition
1	SAT	School Assessment Team
2	SNA	Support Needs Assessment
3	SBST	School Based Support Team
4	NQF	National Qualification Framework
5	PoE	Portfolio of Evidence
6	SAP	School Assessment Plan
7	NPA	National Protocol on Assessment
8	DECAPS	Differentiated Curriculum and Assessment Policy
9	ISP	Individual Support Plan

10	OHS	Occupational Health and Safety
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8.APPLICATION AND SCOPE

This policy will apply to Learners, Staff members, parents /guardian of Nokuthula Learners

9.Reference and Legislation

- National Protocol on Assessment
- National Policy pertaining program and Promotion
- Differentiated National Curriculum and Assessment Policy Statement
- Moderation guidelines 2014
- White paper 6; inclusion
- Circular 73 / 2008
- Circular I of 2014
- Occupational Health and Safety Act 85 of 1993

10 Principles of Assessment

Assessment are :

- Systematically within the grades and subjects
- Relevant and appropriate
- Fair, Manageable and integrated into a learning
- Flexible, meaningful and motivating
- A measure to progress and achievement

In addition, sufficient evidence of learning which is gathered is:

- Valid
- Current
- Authentic
- **The following types of assessment are use:**
 - Baseline Assessment to identify and recognize prior learning
 - Formative Assessment to assess Learning during a unit, so as to identify areas for development
 - Diagnostic assessment to identify difficulties/barriers may be experiencing

11 School Assessment Team

School Assessment team (SAT) is the internal curriculum delivery monitoring team within the school

11.1 Composition of SAT

- Principal
- Deputy principal/s
- Departmental Heads

- Educator Representatives from each Grade

11.2 Roles of each member

11.2.1 Principal

- Monitors implementation of assessment policy and plans
- Communicate the information to and from the district
- Ratify assessment management
- Direct the interventions in the areas of need
- Compiles reports, summarizing work of committee and comment on the progress
- Sign and approve progress reports

11.2.2 Deputy principal

- Monitors departmental heads curriculum management.
- Calls meeting to structure or to review Assessment policy
- Provide support with regard to SAT implementation Plan
- Attend SAT meetings and report back to the principal
- Compile grade Analyzed results and report to the principal
- Manage and maintain the assessment Master file

11.2.3 Departmental head

- Plan SAT implementation plan and communicate the plan with SAT prior approval
- Guide implementation through one-on-one meeting with educators
- Do class visit and support educators
- Moderate learner's tasks designed by educators and support where needed
- Develop strategies to explain and discuss new approaches for developing tasks, educators' assessments plan, assessment tools interventions
- Analyse the grade results and report to the Deputy Principal
- Ensures that each educator adheres to program of assessment

11.2.4 Grade representative

- Represent the grade educator's perspective
- Report information in the grade meeting

12.SAT meetings:

A schedule SAT meeting must be held at least once a month as per school Assessment management plan

12.1 Agenda Items for SAT Meeting

- School Assessment Management plan (important dates) to be developed or discussed each term
- Monthly report on following:
 - Learners Portfolios
 - Tasks moderation and moderation plan
 - Workbooks
 - Practical Tasks
 - Oral Tasks
 - Assessment Tools
 - Learners Performance in administered tasks
 - Individual support Plan (ISP)
 - Distribution of Assessment Plans to parents

13. Learners at Risk

7.1 A School Based Support Team (SBST) is established to provide intervention for learners who requires support. (SBST policy to consulted)

- Communication to parent
- Completion of SNA forms
- Referral of learners at Risk to SBT

14 Assessment plans

- Educators submit their assessment goals to the departmental head per term
- School Assessment Plan to be issued to parents within the first two weeks of the beginning of the school term
- The SAP should be a working document and it must be monitored monthly for compliance by SAT

15. Learner's assessment tasks

Assessment should be grade and age appropriate.

- The Assessment tasks should be carefully designed and weighted to cover all the outcome.
- The design of these tasks should therefore ensure that the variety of skills are assessed
- A copy of learners assessment tasks and the assessment records should be kept for three years

16. Formal Tasks Implementation: (refer to D-CAPS) page 205-206 LIFE SKILLS DECAPS)

- Ensure that the formal assessment task coincides with the practical skills and theoretical work embedded in the practical skill corresponding with the tasks performed on that day or within the previous week,
- Explain the task to guide the learner, show an example of the completed task in order for the learner to know exactly what to do and what is expected;

Divide the class, according to abilities, in more than one group and give a task with similar content, but differentiated in terms of level of difficulty, abstractness or method of questioning, to all the learners.

- The way in which the assessment task is set should be in reach of the learners' level of development whilst also setting targets for the next step of development.
- Assessment task could be set to assess theoretical knowledge within a set time, allowing for assessment accommodations in line with learners' individual needs;
- Write the date of expected completion of the task in the learner's book or observation book
- Compile a suitable assessment tool; and
- Formal assessment should reflect twenty percent (20 %) theoretical knowledge embedded in practical work. Eighty percent (80%) should be practical work.
- The formal assessment requirements are indicated in the formal School-Based Assessments table. In the three core subjects, the ratio may be adapted to the needs of the learners.
- The focus however must be on practical skills and not on the written tasks.

Formal School-Based Assessments			
Term 1	Term 2	Term 3	Term 4
Minimum of 1 worksheet/test/activity per term in order for 20 % of rating codes to reflect on theoretical Knowledge	Minimum of 1 worksheet/test/activity per term in order for 20 % of rating codes to reflect on theoretical Knowledge	Minimum of 1 worksheet/test/activity per term in order for 20 % of rating codes to reflect on theoretical Knowledge	Minimum of 1 worksheet/test/activity per term in order for 20 % of rating codes to reflect on theoretical Knowledge
Minimum of 4 practical assessment tasks or activities in order for 80% of rating codes to reflect on different practical skills	Minimum of 4 practical assessment tasks or activities in order for 80% of rating codes to reflect on different practical skills	Minimum of 4 practical assessment tasks or activities in order for 80% of rating codes to reflect on different practical skills	Minimum of 4 practical assessment tasks or activities in order for 80% of rating codes to reflect on different practical skills

In Creative Arts and Art and Crafts, the above table is not applicable. In these two subjects, a minimum of 4 practical assessment tasks should be completed. Theoretical content will not be assessed. Refer to the learning programs for assessment requirements.

In Physical Education assessment, the above tables do not apply. Refer to the learning program for assessment.

Assessment in the CAPS Grades R to 5 for learners with Severe Intellectual Disability is underpinned by objective of the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).

THESE OBJECTIVES ARE TO:

- Create an integrated national framework for learning achievements;
- Facilitate access to and progression within education, training and career paths;
- Enhance the quality of education and training;
- Redress unfair discrimination and past imbalances and thereby accelerate employment opportunities

17. Quality assurance and moderation of assessment

According to the National Protocol for Assessment – Grade R-12: “Moderation should ensure that the quality and standard of the School-Based Assessment, as contemplated in Chapter 4 of the Curriculum

and Assessment Policy Statements, has been met from Grade 4 onwards (NPA - Page 5)Both School-Based Assessment and the Practical Assessment Task components must: (d) Be available for monitoring and moderation

- School Assessment Team is required to ensure that moderation is conducted by Heads of Department
These must be closely monitored by Deputy principal/s.

17.1 Moderation procedure :

17.1.1 Pre- moderation (pre- moderation tool should be completed)

- The draft task will be carefully moderated by the departmental head and ensures that:
 - The content of the tasks is aligned to D-CAPS and are differentiated.
 - There are no errors spelling, typing errors,
 - All diagrams and pictures are depicted clearly
 - The finalized printed task is of good quality to ensure that learners are not disadvantaged when completing the task.
 - The departmental head will ensure that all changes requested have been implemented
 - The approved tasks is returned to the educator within three days
 - The educator will ensure the correct number of copies are made

17.1.2 post-moderation

- Post moderation tools will be completed during post moderation
- 10% of the marked tasks will be post moderated
- A copy of a designed marked tasks, a marking memorandum and the assessment tool must be included as well
- Moderators/ departmental heads are expected to remark the selected script with the black pen, as it is the responsibility of the moderator to make sure that the:
 - The standard of marking the tasks by the educator is correct, consistent and fair
 - Interpretation of the memo by the educator, is accurate.
- The moderator (DH) must approve the working mark sheet and submit to the educator
- Moderator (DH) must give constructive feedback to educator and scores should be adjusted where necessary using the post moderation tool.

18. Recording and Reporting

Refer to chapter 7 of NPA(National Protocol on Assessment)

18.1Recording

The main instruments for recording evidence of Learners progress are:

- Recording Sheets
- Checklist
- Rubric
- Observation sheet

18.1.1 Guidelines on recording:

- Record must easily interpret and readily accessible
- Record should be easily accessible to parents or senior managers on request
- The recorded material or activities must be a true reflection of planning, teaching and learning activities
- Levels and descriptors are to be used in recording Learner's progress as well as comments where possible

18.2Reporting

- A combination of scores, comments and level descriptors are to be used in recording a pupil's progress.
- The progress report should always be a combination of both the Narrative form and the rating code
 - The educators should report about learner's progress to the departmental heads
 - Departmental Heads report about the learner's progress to the Deputy principal
 - The deputy Principal should report about the learner's progress to the principal
 - The report is standardized, in accordance with **NPA Chapter 7**.
 - One written report per term is sent to the parents/guardian of the Learner.
 - Quarterly meetings are arranged involving parents, Educators, Head of Therapist and SMT
 - A copy of the pupil's report must be filed in the pupil profile.
 - Parents can make an appointment to see a teacher at a set time in the new term or consult teacher at a Parents' meeting/evening.
 - Parents' meetings/ evenings are held in each term.
 - Open days are held twice a year for parents to come view their learners work and discuss learners' performance with the educators

19.ASSESSMENT METHODS

- The following methods of Assessment are used at Nokuthula Special School, taking into consideration the type of Learners in the school

19.1 Observation

- Observing a student in the learning environment is a very powerful Assessment Method. It can also help to change or to enhance a specific teaching strategy. Observation can be done in a group setting while the child is engaged in a learning tasks
- On a daily basis or at the beginning of a lesson educator will use observation to identity the interests of individual Learners especially strength that can be built upon.

19.2 Presentation

- It's a verbal demonstration of skills, knowledge and understanding

19.3 Practical tasks

- The teacher should guide a practical Task. Learners should understand the Assessment criteria and the Learning Outcomes for each practical task.

19.4 Diagnostic Assessment

- This Assessment is used to collect data on what the Learners has already know about the topic
- The goal is to get a Snapshot of where Learners currently stand – Intellectually, emotionally, or ideologically.

19.5 Projects

- Projects involves both teacher-guided and/or independent work. Clear criteria, stating how performance will be measured, should be available prior to the Activity

20.Describing Performance

The following codes are used for recording and reporting Learner's performance but we don't report percentages to parents. These Rating codes are used in the progress report.

Rating code	Description	Percentage
7	Outstanding achievement	80-100
6	Meritorious achievement	70- 79
5	Substantial achievement	60-69
4	Adequate achievement	50-59
3	Moderate achievement	40-49
2	Elementary achievement	30-39
1	Not achieved	0-29

21 Analysis of results

- Diagnostic and statistical analysis of Learner performance must be done after each formal assessment task, on an internal document. Each subject teacher is responsible for this.
- Diagnostic analysis should inform Intervention strategies.
- Analysis should be utilized to support Learners and to improve teaching and learning.

22. Assessment Files

Each teacher/facilitator should have a well arrange assessment file containing:

- Assessment planning per learning
- Learners' tasks ad tools
- Moderation tools
- Tasks monitoring tools
- Assessment policies and instructions
- A Copy of learner's progress report per term
- Assessment goals per learning area per term

23. Educators are responsible for keeping:

- Their copies of students' marked assessments as evidence, per learner
- Copies of administered Learners tasks and memorandums are to be kept in assessment file
- Learner's assessments tasks must be kept for the whole year and Term 4's assessments must be kept for six months

24. Portfolio of Evidence and portfolios

24.1 Portfolio of Evidence

- Every learner must have a Portfolio of Evidence (PoE) containing all activities preferably learners in the skills classrooms
- Learners' portfolio of Evidence should contain written and visual overviews of projects and significant pieces end products of their work, it should also include a assessment goals of the skills taught, method of teaching and the relevant outcome or learners achievement
- All work must contain the Learner's name. The teacher is responsible to monitor the learner's portfolio of evidence.
- The Departmental Head will control the Assessment and PoE files and processes during class visits and school book control times.

24.2 Portfolio

The learner portfolio should be used to (page 11 NPA)

- **Track progress, growth achievements of the learner with regard to expected outcome.**
Every learner at Nokuthula special should have a portfolio. Preferably learners in Grade R- Grade three (3). These learners are not doing skills subject but it is important for them to also have portfolio to be presented to parents on open days.

24.2.1 The Portfolio encompasses:

- The selection of a learner's work by the learner
- The selection of the learner's work by the educator
- The learner's work that can be used to show development and progress over a specified period of time Assessed tasks which can be used to determine standards between schools and within a system.

25. SHORT TITLE

This policy shall be called : Assessment policy for Nokuthula Special School

26. APPROVAL:

Recommended by : Principal Name	Nompumza Nomathemba	Signature	
Approved by : SGB Chairperson	Josephine Ntshali	Signature	
Verified by GDE: District Director		Signature	
Date of Verification			
Certified by (Print name)			

27 . Suggestions for Changes or Edition

Date	Heading to be edited / brief description for changes	Entered by

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